Mechnikov approximately five days to reach that point, meaning that Mazur would have to wait another five days to get to Odesa and might very well die en route. The captain of the *Iziaslav* was instructed that at worst he could admit Mazur to a hospital in Sicily or in Alexandria, Egypt, but only under escort of a Soviet official who would prevent doctors from asking Mazur any question not directly related to his health condition. Under no circumstances was Mazur to be left in British Gibraltar.

Operation Anadyr had to be conducted in complete secrecy. No one could leave the ship once its cargo had been loaded, especially when it was en route to Cuba. Zozulia, who subsequently filed a report on his trip aboard the *Ilia Mechnikov*, later learned to his horror that Mazur's health had deteriorated so badly that the captain of the *Iziaslav* deemed it necessary to deliver him to a hospital in Gibraltar. Mazur survived against all odds. The sad irony of the situation was that neither Mazur nor Zozulia himself knew the ship's destination at the time. The relevant instructions were in an envelope that the captain could open only after passing through the Strait of Gibraltar. The *Ilia Mechnikov*, as it turned out, was heading for the port town of Nuevitas on the northern shore of Cuba. But when the ship reached its destination, it was redirected to another port, on the southern shore of the island. This was not a deliberate attempt to mislead the Americans but the result of general disorganization. The ship's cargo was eventually unloaded on August 30 and 31 in Santiago de Cuba.[3]

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THE COMMUNICATIONS EQUIPMENT BROUGHT TO CUBA BY the *Ilya Mechnikov* belonged to Colonel Georgii Voronkov's 27th Antiaircraft Missile Division. It would be used a month and a half later to deliver the order to shoot down an American U-2 plane over Cuba.

Voronkov's division, also known as Antiaircraft Division no. 10, or the Volgograd Division (after its location in the Soviet Union), was the first of two missile divisions dispatched to Cuba on a priority basis once the Soviet General Staff recognized that it would be impossible to conceal the strategic missiles on Cuban territory, and that antiaircraft missiles would be required